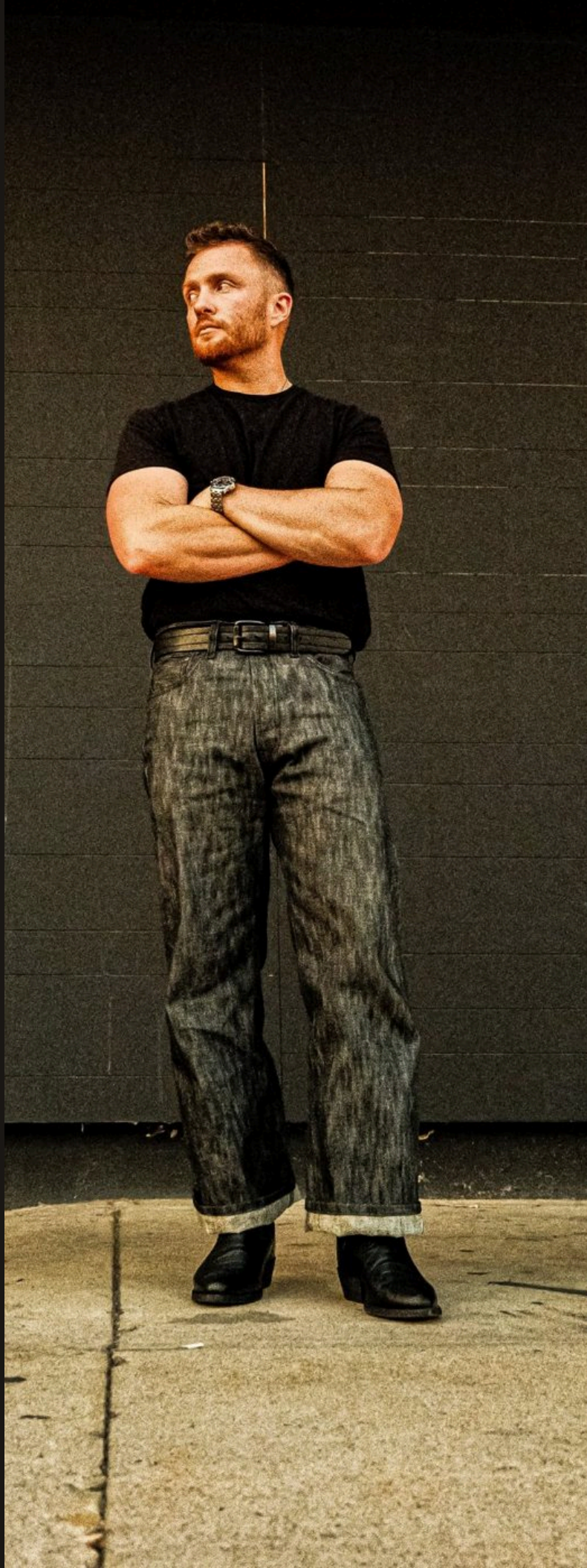
THE PILLAR METHOD

FREE STYLE GUIDE

# YOUR FIRST 10 PIECES

The 10 clothes every man should own, how they should fit, and how to wear them together.

BY MITCH · @GOOSEFITNESSS



START HERE

# 10 GOOD PIECES. THAT'S IT.

**You don't need a closet full of clothes. You need 10 good pieces that fit you and work together.**

I've loved clothes since middle school, when I dressed up in a suit for basketball game days. At my first job I studied color combinations and how to wear a suit properly, and I learned the rest from guys on YouTube who knew more than me. Today I wear Americana heritage menswear: selvedge denim, good boots, and classic pieces with a little Golden Era bodybuilding mixed in.

I also know what it's like to stand in front of the mirror and not like what you see. I was the bigger kid. I've been 249 lb and I've been on stage. Through all of it, I learned that clothes that fit and suit you change how you carry yourself, at any size.

This guide is for the man who wants to dress like the man he wants to become. Start with these 10 pieces. Build from there.

— Mitch



BEFORE YOU BUY ANYTHING

# THE 3 GROUND RULES

## 1. FIT COMES FIRST

Not too tight, not too baggy. A $20 shirt that fits beats a $200 shirt that doesn't. Check these every time you try something on:

- **Shoulders:** the seam sits at the edge of your shoulder, not down your arm.
- **Chest and stomach:** the fabric lies flat. No pulling across the buttons, no tent of extra cloth.
- **Sleeves:** a tee sleeve hugs the arm about halfway down the bicep. A shirt cuff ends at the base of your thumb.
- **Pants:** they sit at your waist without a belt doing all the work, and the leg falls straight without bunching up on your shoes.

## 2. KEEP YOUR COLORS SIMPLE

Build on a small set of colors that all work together:



NAVY · BLACK · WHITE · LIGHT BLUE · GREY · OLIVE · BROWN

- **Base colors:** navy, black, white, light blue, grey, olive and brown. Almost any two of these go together.
- **Leathers match:** your belt and your boots are the same color family. That's why both are brown on this list.
- **One thing at a time:** wear one bold color or pattern per outfit, like a plaid flannel, and keep the rest plain.

## 3. BUILD AN INTERCHANGEABLE WARDROBE

Every piece on this list works with almost every other piece. That's the point. When your clothes complement each other, 10 pieces turn into dozens of outfits. You stop spending your mornings figuring out what to wear: grab any top, any bottom and the boots, and you're dressed.

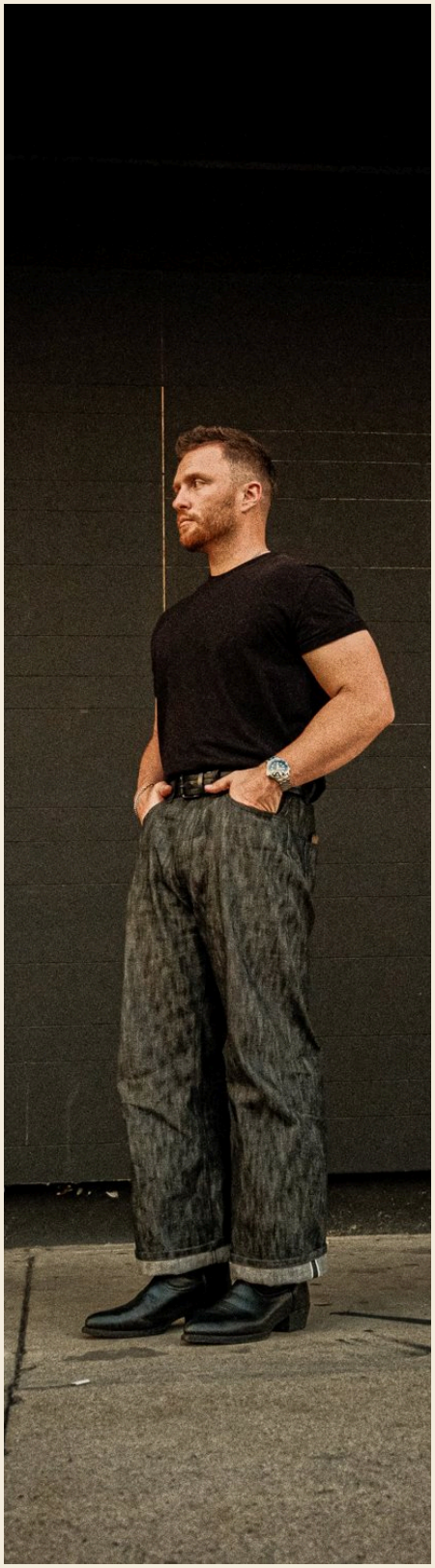
FIT AND BODY TYPE

# DRESS FOR YOUR BUILD

The same 10 pieces work on every body. What changes is how you wear them.

| YOUR BUILD | WHAT TO AIM FOR | WHAT TO AVOID |
|---|---|---|
| **Skinny** | Thicker fabrics (heavyweight tees, flannel, denim jackets) to add bulk; slim but not skin-tight fits; layering | Oversized clothes that swallow you; very thin, clingy tees |
| **Muscular** | Room in the chest, shoulders and thighs; straight-leg denim as the base of your outfit; no stretch: clothes that fit properly, made from good natural materials | Shirts that pull at the buttons; "one size down" to show off |
| **Bigger** | Structured pieces (oxford, chore coat, a suit jacket) that hold their shape; darker colors on top; straight-leg denim as the base of your outfit; no stretch: clothes that fit properly, made from good natural materials | Clingy fabrics; too tight around the middle; going baggy to hide |

Whatever your build, proportion is the goal: your clothes should follow your shape, not fight it. And if your body is changing because you're putting in the work, buy for the body you have today. Clothes that fit now will make you feel better on the way there.



THE LIST

# THE 10 PIECES

## 01 HEAVYWEIGHT WHITE TEE

The foundation of everything else. A thick cotton tee holds its shape and hides less-than-perfect spots better than a thin one.

**FIT** sleeves hug the arm, hem ends around the middle of your zipper.

## 02 PIQUÉ COTTON POLO

The classic polo, a step up from a tee. The textured cotton holds its shape, frames your shoulders and works with jeans, chinos or under a jacket.

**FIT** close through the chest, not clinging to the stomach.

## 03 LIGHT BLUE OXFORD BUTTON-DOWN

Goes with jeans, chinos and the suit. Wear it tucked or untucked, sleeves rolled or down.

**FIT** no pulling at the buttons; cuffs at the base of your thumb.

## 04 FLANNEL WORK SHIRT

The heritage everyday shirt. Wear it open over the white tee or buttoned up on its own. This is your one pattern.

**FIT** room to layer a tee under it without being boxy.

## 05 DARK SELVEDGE DENIM JEANS

One pair of dark jeans goes with everything on this list and dresses up better than faded denim.

**FIT** straight leg, not tapered, with a small break or a clean cuff above the boots.



## 06 BROWN OR OLIVE CHINOS

The "nicer than jeans" pants for church, dinner or the office.

**FIT** straight leg, no bunching.

## 07 BROWN LEATHER BOOT

A cap-toe lace-up or a Chelsea boot. Good boots make every outfit here look intentional, and they last for years.

**FIT** snug at the heel, room to wiggle your toes.

## 08 BROWN LEATHER BELT

Small piece, big finish. It ties your boots and your outfit together.

**FIT** the buckle closes on the middle hole.

## 09 NAVY OR CHARCOAL SUIT

For weddings, interviews, funerals and the days that matter. The jacket also works on its own over jeans or chinos.

**FIT** shoulders end at your shoulders; jacket sleeves show about half an inch of shirt cuff.

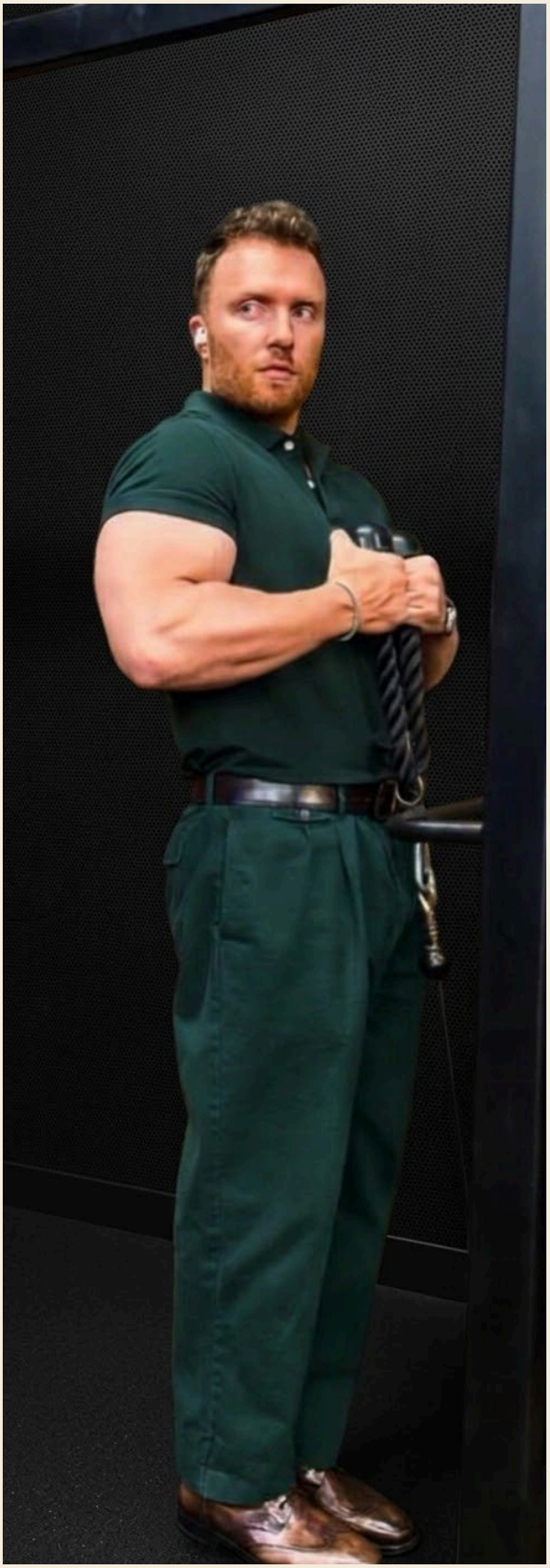
## 10 DENIM JACKET OR CHORE COAT

Rugged outerwear with Americana roots. Throw it over any top on this list.

**FIT** room for a flannel underneath, sleeves end at your wrist.

### NO USE FOR A SUIT?

If you have no use for a suit in your life, I still recommend having a navy blazer on hand in order to dress up your outfits for certain occasions.



WHERE TO BUY

# TWO PRICE LEVELS FOR EACH PIECE

Start where your budget is. Every name below links to the product.

| PIECE | GOOD QUALITY | HIGH QUALITY |
|---|---|---|
| **White tee** | True Classic Heavyweight Crew | Whitesville, or Buck Mason Toughknit tee |
| **Piqué cotton polo** | Quince, Brooks Brothers, or Ralph Lauren | Luca Faloni or Sunspel Riviera |
| **Oxford button-down** | J.Crew Broken-In Oxford or Uniqlo Oxford Shirt | Kamakura Vintage Ivy or Drake's |
| **Flannel shirt** | L.L. Bean Scotch Plaid or Wrangler Flannel | Iron Heart Ultra Heavy Flannel or Filson Vintage Flannel |
| **Dark denim** | Naked & Famous (Strong or True Guy fit, 100% cotton selvedge only) or Time Catcher 1955 Classic Biker Jeans | The Long Haul, Freenote Cloth, or Momotaro |
| **Chinos** | J.Crew Broken-in Straight Chino (100% cotton) | Buzz Rickson's 1942 Army Chino or Buck Mason Big Chino |
| **Brown leather boot** | Thursday Captain | Thursday Black Label or Made in USA, or Brake House |
| **Brown leather belt** | Rose Anvil Micro-Adjust Belt | Filson Bridle Leather Belt or Tanner Goods |
| **Suit** | Spier & Mackay or Suitsupply | Brooks Brothers 1818, or Ralph Lauren Purple Label |
| **Denim jacket or chore coat** | Levi's Trucker, Dickies Denim Chore Coat or Colour Plane French Chore Coat | Levi's Vintage Clothing Type II, or Le Laboureur or Le Mont Saint Michel Chore Coat |

*These are my current suggestions and are subject to change.*

PUT IT TOGETHER

# 6 OUTFITS FROM THE SAME 10 PIECES

This is the interchangeable wardrobe in action. Every outfit below uses only pieces from the list.

| OCCASION | TOP | BOTTOM | LAYER | SHOES AND BELT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Weekend** | White tee | Dark denim | Flannel (Ralph tuck or worn open) | Boot + belt |
| **Cool day out** | White tee | Dark denim | Denim jacket or chore coat | Boot + belt |
| **Date night** | Piqué polo | Dark denim | Suit jacket | Boot + belt |
| **Office or church** | Oxford button-down | Chinos | Suit jacket | Boot + belt |
| **Smart casual** | Piqué polo | Chinos | Denim jacket or chore coat | Boot + belt |
| **Wedding or interview** | Oxford button-down | Suit | None | Boot + belt |

### THE MATH

3 tops × 2 bottoms × 3 layer options is already 18 combinations, before you count the suit. That's the interchangeable wardrobe doing its job.

## YOUR CHECKLIST

Check off what you already own. What's left is your shopping list.

- ☐ 01 **Heavyweight white tee**
- ☐ 02 **Piqué cotton polo**
- ☐ 03 **Light blue oxford button-down**
- ☐ 04 **Flannel work shirt**
- ☐ 05 **Dark selvedge denim jeans**
- ☐ 06 **Brown or olive chinos**
- ☐ 07 **Brown leather boot**
- ☐ 08 **Brown leather belt**
- ☐ 09 **Navy or charcoal suit**
- ☐ 10 **Denim jacket or chore coat**

MONEY

# BUILDING IT WITHOUT GOING BROKE

**You don't have to buy all 10 pieces this month. Start with what you'll wear most, usually the tee, the jeans and the boots, and add one piece at a time.**

## THINK IN COST PER WEAR

The price tag isn't what a piece really costs you. Divide the price by the number of times you'll wear it: a $200 pair of boots you wear 300 times costs about 67 cents a wear, while a $60 pair that falls apart after 30 wears costs $2 a wear. Cheap clothes that wear out fast are the expensive ones. Spend more on what you'll wear the most, and less on what you'll wear the least.

**$0.67**

$200 boots ÷ 300 wears

**$2.00**

$60 boots ÷ 30 wears

## WHEN MONEY IS TIGHT

- **Buy secondhand.** Heritage brands like Brooks Brothers, Polo Ralph Lauren, L.L. Bean and J.Crew were built to last, and they show up in thrift stores, on eBay and in resale apps for a fraction of the new price.
- **Check the fabric, not just the label.** Look for 100% cotton, wool and real leather. Skip pieces with pilling, stretched collars or cracked leather.
- **Pay for tailoring.** A cheap item that's been taken in to fit you looks better than an expensive one that hasn't.

## WHEN YOU'RE READY TO INVEST

Put your money into the pieces that take the most wear: boots, denim and outerwear. Brands like Thursday Boots and Brake House make boots and leather goods that can last for years with basic care.

YOUR NEXT STEP

# STYLE IS ONE PILLAR.

The Pillar Method works on all three: physical, mental and spiritual.

| PHYSICAL | MENTAL | SPIRITUAL |
|---|---|---|

If you're ready to change how you look, how you feel and how you show up, I'm taking 5 founding clients for my 12-week coaching program.

**APPLY AT PILLARMETHODCOACHING.COM**

Not ready yet? Follow along on Instagram at @goosefitnesss, and watch your inbox. I'll keep sending honest notes on training, style and faith.



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